Cardano Governance Survey for DReps

Thank you for participating in this survey. This research initiative aims to measure and improve governance on the Cardano blockchain. Your responses will help us understand governance participation, decision-making, and areas for improvement.

Resources available:

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M1-A - What, if any, is the biggest barrier preventing you from participating more actively in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- ○ Governance proposals are too technical to evaluate
- ○ Voting tools are difficult to access or use
- ○ Not enough time to review proposals before voting deadlines
- ○ Unclear what impact my participation would have / perception of lack of impact
- ○ Current deposit or fee requirements
- ○ Inadequate compensation / incentives
- ○ Delays in Constitutional Committee decisions / rationale publication
- ○ Lack of confidence in ability to evaluate the safety / performance implications of technical governance actions (e.g., protocol parameter changes, hard forks)?
- ◉ No significant barrier - I participate as much as I do or don't prefer

M1-B - What type of information would most help you make governance decisions? (Select one)

- (●) Expert analysis of proposal technical implications
- ( ) How DReps and SPOs are planning to vote
- ( ) Historical outcomes of similar past proposals
- ( ) Constitutional Committee's assessment of proposals
- ( ) Evaluation of whether projected cost aligns with similar past proposals
- ( ) I have sufficient information to make decisions

M2-A - What, if any, do you think is the biggest barrier preventing ada holders from delegating their voting power to a DRep to vote on their behalf? (Select one)

- ( ) Hard to discover what DReps exist
- ( ) DReps don't clearly communicate their values or positions
- ( ) Difficult to compare DReps to each other
- ( ) Ada holders don't trust available DReps to represent their interests
- ( ) Ada holders prefer to vote directly
- (●) No significant barrier - delegation is accessible

M2-B - Where do you think ada holders most commonly look for information when selecting a DRep? (Select one)

- ○ Publicly accessible governance tools for participating in governance workflows
- ○ Publicly accessible blockchain explorer tools showing on-chain state and history
- ○ DRep profiles and published political / governance perspectives
- ○ Community forums or social media recommendations
- ○ SPO or other trusted community member endorsements
- ◉ They don't look for information - they delegate to someone they already know
- ○ They have not tried to find a DRep

M3-A - Of these options, what would most likely cause delegators to change their DRep delegation? (Select one)

- ○ DRep not publishing on-chain rationales for their votes
- ○ DRep not providing accessible communication in informal channels
- ○ DRep becoming inactive or missing votes
- ○ DRep voted in a way I disagreed with
- ◉ Learning about a DRep with different values or voting patterns
- ○ I would not change my delegation / Not applicable

M4/M5-A - Do you think DRep voting power has become more concentrated since the role was established? If so what do you think contributes most to this change? (Select one)

- ○ Difficult for ada holders to discover smaller or newer DReps
- ◉ Well-known DReps attract more delegation regardless of performance
- ○ Lack of incentives for delegating to smaller DReps
- ○ Ada holders don't actively manage or reconsider their delegations
- ○ Default delegation options in wallet applications
- ○ Ada holders choosing the same DRep as their SPO has chosen
- ○ Some DReps are simply more qualified or trusted
- ○ Genesis Ada given to large organizations who delegate to DReps
- ○ I don't believe voting power is overly concentrated
- ○ Other

M4/M5-B - What, if any, would most help distribute voting power more evenly across DReps? (Select one)

- ○ Better tools for discovering and comparing DReps
- ○ Incentives for delegating to smaller or newer DReps
- ◉ Limits on maximum voting power per DRep
- ○ More support for new DReps to establish themselves
- ○ Easier process to switch DReps
- ○ Encouraging ada holders to periodically review their delegation
- ○ No changes needed - current distribution is appropriate

M6-A - What would most help increase the number of DReps publishing on-chain rationales? (Select one)

- ○ Clearer templates or standards for rationale format
- ○ Simpler tools for publishing rationales
- ○ Incentives or rewards for publishing rationales
- ◉ Community recognition for DReps who consistently publish
- ○ Making rationale publication a requirement for active DRep status
- ○ Delegator pressure / delegators moving away from a DRep
- ○ No changes needed - current publication rates are adequate

M7-A - What, if any, would most help increase the number of active DReps in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- ○ Better onboarding resources and mentorship for new DReps
- ○ Reduced deposit requirements to register as a DRep
- ◉ Compensation or incentives for active DRep participation
- ○ Improved tools for DReps to communicate with potential delegators
- ○ Greater visibility for new DReps in discovery platforms
- ○ Easier ways for a group of people to act as a DReps, rather than an individual
- ○ No changes needed - current DRep numbers are adequate

M10-B - What is an acceptable timeframe for the Constitutional Committee to review and vote on a governance action? (Select one)

- ○ Within 1 epoch (5 days)
- ◉ Within 2-3 epochs (10-15 days)
- ○ Within 4-6 epochs (20-30 days) - Maximum before action expires
- ○ Depends on the complexity of the proposal
- ○ I don't have an expectation for CC response time

What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

Better DRep filters

Which of these roles best describes your involvement in the Cardano ecosystem? (Select all that apply)

- [ ] Ada Holder
- [x] DRep (Delegated Representative)
- [ ] SPO (Stake Pool Operator)
- [ ] CC (Constitutional Committee Member)
- [ ] Proposal Submitter / Project Catalyst Veteran
- [ ] Developer
- [ ] Researcher / Academic
- [ ] General Community Member / Enthusiast
- [ ] Governance Tooling Projects
- [ ] Other Cardano Project

How long have you been actively serving as a DRep?

- ○ Less than 3 months
- ○ 3 to 6 months
- ○ 6 to 12 months
- ◉ 1 year or longer

Thank you!
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Google Skjemaer

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- ○ I would not change my delegation / Not applicable

M4/M5-A - Do you think DRep voting power has become more concentrated since the role was established? If so what do you think contributes most to this change? (Select one)

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- ◉ Default delegation options in wallet applications
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- ○ No changes needed - current distribution is appropriate

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M10-B - What is an acceptable timeframe for the Constitutional Committee to review and vote on a governance action? (Select one)

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What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

Communication platform for all DReps

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How long have you been actively serving as a DRep?

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- ○ 3 to 6 months
- ○ 6 to 12 months
- ◉ 1 year or longer

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M10-B - What is an acceptable timeframe for the Constitutional Committee to review and vote on a governance action? (Select one)

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What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

Development of better guidelines for dreps, spos, cc members, budget comm, isc, tsc, cmc,gwc, osc,cpc when to comes to disseminating information, were still not where we need to be and are still either doubling work, not working to each others strengths or assisting on each others weaknesses. Coordination there will only be possible if the intersect admin creates administrative team to identify the issues and the fix them, currently thats not really being done

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What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

I think the main issue in Cardanos governance system is the dRep delegation issue.
A handful of dReps with sufficient power to decide what gets funded and supported and what doesn't.
This is the thing that totally undermines our governance aspirations. It's the thing that means we have failed to set up a new model that could be a template for others. Its the main failure in delivering what Charles described repeatedly and extensively for years. It's the thing that means we can't promote, publicise or market our governance story - because the moment we do, people will see it's an oligopoly of a dozen or so companies entities and people holding all the actual power.
We'd be laughed at if we publicly promoted this in the same terms as we discuss it, as a better form of participatory democracy.
It's the thing that is the most open, glaring and obvious avenue for corruption and back room deals.
Many of those powerful dReps want or need certain treasury proposals to go through. Many of them would very much like quite generous catalyst proposals to be approved for themselves. And they all have each others contact details and many have long standing relationships. The door to this kind of corruption is lying wide open. There is not one person or mechanism in all of governance dedicated to checking and investigating this. And even if anything untoward was discovered theres nothing to hold anyone to account, or even to do anything about it. Because doing something about it would obviously entail closing the possibility of more corruption, which means fixing the dRep delegation problem!
We aren't going to have any more or less ability to fix the problem after it's exploited for fraud than we have right now.
So maybe the priority of Cardanos governance should be on focusing on the problem now.
Not later, or never.

And sadly every branch of Cardanos governance seems content to absolutely ignore this primary failing.
Small dReps are dropping out because this issue makes their voice meaningless.
DReps vote and participate less than they otherwise would because this issue makes their voice meaningless.
Participation in every level and aspect of governance is less than what it otherwise would be, because this issue makes that participation meaningless.
The engagement, the participation, the social cohesion and community strength of the ecosystem is all significantly less than what it could be, because of this issue.
Every question in the this questionnaire, and the questionnaire itself, only exist because of this issue!
If this issue was fixed you wouldn't have the problems that necessitate this questionnaire.
How do you get people to care and participate in all aspects of governance?? You make their voice, opinion and vote meaningful.
So, in answer to the question, what improvement to governance would I like to see?
Perhaps a focus on fixing the main problem?

This questionnaire could be improved. Some of the above questions should have allowed multiple answers, numbered in order of importance. Without this, the answers you get to some questions are not going to represent the full picture of the respondents understanding of the situation - you'll get a picture of what they think the main issue is, but what you should want, for this survey to be useful, is a picture of what they think all the issues are to a particular situation in order of their perceived priority. Most questions in this kind of survey should have an 'other' option, and the ability to write something new. Without the ability to write something new, the 'other' option is meaningless to you.

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- [ ] Other Cardano Project

How long have you been actively serving as a DRep?

- ( ) Less than 3 months
- ( ) 3 to 6 months
- ( ) 6 to 12 months
- (•) 1 year or longer

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Google Skjemaer

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- ○ Not enough time to review proposals before voting deadlines
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- ○ Inadequate compensation / incentives
- ○ Delays in Constitutional Committee decisions / rationale publication
- ○ Lack of confidence in ability to evaluate the safety / performance implications of technical governance actions (e.g., protocol parameter changes, hard forks)?
- ◉ No significant barrier - I participate as much as I do or don't prefer

M1-B - What type of information would most help you make governance decisions? (Select one)

- ○ Expert analysis of proposal technical implications
- ○ How DReps and SPOs are planning to vote
- ◉ Historical outcomes of similar past proposals
- ○ Constitutional Committee's assessment of proposals
- ○ Evaluation of whether projected cost aligns with similar past proposals
- ○ I have sufficient information to make decisions

M2-A - What, if any, do you think is the biggest barrier preventing ada holders from delegating their voting power to a DRep to vote on their behalf? (Select one)

- ○ Hard to discover what DReps exist
- ○ DReps don't clearly communicate their values or positions
- ○ Difficult to compare DReps to each other
- ◉ Ada holders don't trust available DReps to represent their interests
- ○ Ada holders prefer to vote directly
- ○ No significant barrier - delegation is accessible

M2-B - Where do you think ada holders most commonly look for information when selecting a DRep? (Select one)

- ○ Publicly accessible governance tools for participating in governance workflows
- ◉ Publicly accessible blockchain explorer tools showing on-chain state and history
- ○ DRep profiles and published political / governance perspectives
- ○ Community forums or social media recommendations
- ○ SPO or other trusted community member endorsements
- ○ They don't look for information - they delegate to someone they already know
- ○ They have not tried to find a DRep

M3-A - Of these options, what would most likely cause delegators to change their DRep delegation? (Select one)

- ○ DRep not publishing on-chain rationales for their votes
- ○ DRep not providing accessible communication in informal channels
- ◉ DRep becoming inactive or missing votes
- ○ DRep voted in a way I disagreed with
- ○ Learning about a DRep with different values or voting patterns
- ○ I would not change my delegation / Not applicable

M4/M5-A - Do you think DRep voting power has become more concentrated since the role was established? If so what do you think contributes most to this change? (Select one)

- ○ Difficult for ada holders to discover smaller or newer DReps
- ○ Well-known DReps attract more delegation regardless of performance
- ○ Lack of incentives for delegating to smaller DReps
- ○ Ada holders don't actively manage or reconsider their delegations
- ◉ Default delegation options in wallet applications
- ○ Ada holders choosing the same DRep as their SPO has chosen
- ○ Some DReps are simply more qualified or trusted
- ○ Genesis Ada given to large organizations who delegate to DReps
- ○ I don't believe voting power is overly concentrated
- ○ Other

M4/M5-B - What, if any, would most help distribute voting power more evenly across DReps? (Select one)

- ○ Better tools for discovering and comparing DReps
- ○ Incentives for delegating to smaller or newer DReps
- ◉ Limits on maximum voting power per DRep
- ○ More support for new DReps to establish themselves
- ○ Easier process to switch DReps
- ○ Encouraging ada holders to periodically review their delegation
- ○ No changes needed - current distribution is appropriate

M6-A - What would most help increase the number of DReps publishing on-chain rationales? (Select one)

- ○ Clearer templates or standards for rationale format
- ○ Simpler tools for publishing rationales
- ○ Incentives or rewards for publishing rationales
- ○ Community recognition for DReps who consistently publish
- ○ Making rationale publication a requirement for active DRep status
- ○ Delegator pressure / delegators moving away from a DRep
- ◉ No changes needed - current publication rates are adequate

M7-A - What, if any, would most help increase the number of active DReps in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- ○ Better onboarding resources and mentorship for new DReps
- ○ Reduced deposit requirements to register as a DRep
- ◉ Compensation or incentives for active DRep participation
- ○ Improved tools for DReps to communicate with potential delegators
- ○ Greater visibility for new DReps in discovery platforms
- ○ Easier ways for a group of people to act as a DReps, rather than an individual
- ○ No changes needed - current DRep numbers are adequate

M10-B - What is an acceptable timeframe for the Constitutional Committee to review and vote on a governance action? (Select one)

- ○ Within 1 epoch (5 days)
- ◉ Within 2-3 epochs (10-15 days)
- ○ Within 4-6 epochs (20-30 days) - Maximum before action expires
- ○ Depends on the complexity of the proposal
- ○ I don't have an expectation for CC response time

What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

Which of these roles best describes your involvement in the Cardano ecosystem? (Select all that apply)

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- ○ Difficult to compare DReps to each other
- ○ Ada holders don't trust available DReps to represent their interests
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M2-B - Where do you think ada holders most commonly look for information when selecting a DRep? (Select one)

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M3-A - Of these options, what would most likely cause delegators to change their DRep delegation? (Select one)

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- ◉ DRep becoming inactive or missing votes
- ○ DRep voted in a way I disagreed with
- ○ Learning about a DRep with different values or voting patterns
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M4/M5-A - Do you think DRep voting power has become more concentrated since the role was established? If so what do you think contributes most to this change? (Select one)

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- ○ Ada holders choosing the same DRep as their SPO has chosen
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- ○ Genesis Ada given to large organizations who delegate to DReps
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- ○ No changes needed - current distribution is appropriate

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- ○ Easier ways for a group of people to act as a DReps, rather than an individual
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What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

Governance lacks coordination. DReps do not talk to each other. There is no cooperation between DReps and Intersect/FEs. Governance also lacks experts. We have many influencer DReps. That is why we make bad decisions. DReps do not have the expertise or time to properly assess proposals. Incentives are lacking. It seems that without compensation we cannot improve the quality of the decision-making process.

Which of these roles best describes your involvement in the Cardano ecosystem? (Select all that apply)

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M10-B - What is an acceptable timeframe for the Constitutional Committee to review and vote on a governance action? (Select one)

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- ○ Depends on the complexity of the proposal
- ○ I don’t have an expectation for CC response time

What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

What I would most like to see in governance is the implementation of a clear incentive model for active, qualified, and distributed participation.

The current system shows structural weaknesses across four interconnected dimensions: quorum, deliberative quality, concentration and ossification, and unchecked structural power.

---

1. Minimum Participation and Quorum Failure

Members of the Constitutional Committee, dReps, and SPOs are required to dedicate meaningful time to analyze governance actions, understand technical and policy implications, participate in discussions, vote, and communicate their decisions to delegators. This demands sustained effort, reputational exposure, and intellectual responsibility. Yet the system remains almost entirely dependent on voluntarism.

In February 2026, a parameter update governance action — with clear upside and almost no documented downside — remained open for nearly a month. Despite an overwhelming majority voting in favor, quorum was difficult to reach until the final days before expiration. This was not an isolated event.

When achieving quorum requires intensive mobilization campaigns, public pressure, and social shaming of inactive representatives, the issue is not awareness. It is structural misalignment between responsibility and incentives.

Furthermore, the percentage of active dReps relative to total registered dRePs appears low (likely below 25%), indicating that registration does not translate into consistent participation. If technically conservative and broadly supported actions struggle to reach quorum, more complex or controversial decisions pose even greater systemic risk.

The system is already failing at the minimum threshold: basic participation.

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2. Quality of Deliberation

The problem extends beyond quorum. The quality of participation presents equally concerning signals.

A significant portion of dReps do not publish written justifications for their votes. Among those who do, many justifications are extremely brief, generic, or provide little evidence of rigorous analysis. This weakens transparency, reduces accountability toward delegators, and limits collective learning within the ecosystem.

Governance cannot be measured solely by counted votes. It must also be measured by the depth and clarity of reasoning behind those votes.

There is already academic groundwork in this direction. In 2025, IOG published research modeling reward schemes and effort maximization in proof-of-stake governance, including simulations of different incentive structures. However, no practical and implementable model has yet been adopted.

The urgency is clear: the system is not only struggling to meet quorum; it is also struggling to maintain deliberative quality.

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3. Concentration, Popularity Bias, and Governance Ossification

There is a structural concentration of voting power in a small number of highly influential dReps. Some of this concentration reflects historical and macroeconomic factors — including the ICO distribution in Japan and the higher capital availability in developed economies such as Japan, the United States, and Europe.

However, the absence of mechanisms encouraging redelegation reinforces “sticky delegation.” Delegators rarely reassess their choice, regardless of current performance. This creates governance ossification: individuals who accumulated influence in earlier phases retain it indefinitely, even without proportional ongoing effort or transparency.

Additionally, there is a visible popularity bias in the selection of dReps. Representatives are frequently chosen based on social visibility and engagement rather than demonstrated analytical rigor or decision-making competence. When public signals of quality are weak, the system rewards what is most observable: presence, narrative influence, and social capital.

Expertise is not limited to academic credentials, but a governance system responsible for protocol parameters, treasury allocations, and constitutional interpretation should not default to popularity as its dominant selection mechanism.

This environment also creates perverse incentives. When a small group of dReps is predictably decisive, they become natural targets for lobbying. Structural predictability of influence increases the risk of capture.

Without mechanisms that encourage redistribution of delegation, periodic reassessment, or saturation limits, governance power becomes progressively concentrated and structurally vulnerable.

---

4. Foundational Voting Power and the Absence of dRep Saturation Mechanisms

A further structural concern is the direct exercise of voting power by founding entities that received large token allocations during the ICO.

When an entity with historically significant allocation and ecosystem influence chooses to vote directly or delegate to itself, this raises legitimate concerns about concentration of power and potential conflicts of interest. Other foundational bodies have chosen to delegate to community dRePs instead of consolidating influence internally, demonstrating that alternative governance postures are possible.

In addition, certain wallet interfaces may design user experiences that subtly incentivize delegation toward their own affiliated dRePs, creating indirect barriers to redistribution of power. Even if technically permissible, such design choices may conflict with decentralization principles.

Currently, there is no saturation parameter for dReps comparable to the saturation mechanism for stake pools. This allows unlimited concentration of voting power in a single representative.

Introducing a voting power saturation threshold for dReps could mitigate excessive concentration. This mechanism would need to be designed differently from stake pool saturation, as there is no direct financial reward for delegating to a dRep. Incentives in this context are reputational and governance-based, not yield-based.

Arguments that dRep saturation would enable Sybil attacks require careful analysis. Unlike stake pools, dReps operate with public identities and reputational capital. Fragmenting into multiple public identities would likely trigger reputational costs and community backlash. Fragmenting anonymously would reduce delegation attractiveness due to lack of social trust. The risk profile is therefore materially different from stake pool fragmentation.

Without safeguards against excessive accumulation of governance power, the system remains exposed to progressive centralization and long-term legitimacy erosion.

Conclusion

The current governance model is showing measurable stress signals:

* Difficulty reaching quorum
* Low active participation rates
* Weak deliberative quality
* Concentration of voting power
* Popularity bias in representative selection
* Absence of saturation limits for dReps
* Structural risks associated with foundational voting concentration

These are not isolated problems. They are symptoms of an incentive architecture that has not yet matured to match the responsibilities of Voltaire-era governance.

A sustainable governance system requires:

* Incentives for consistent participation
* Incentives for transparent and reasoned justification
* Mechanisms encouraging redelegation and distribution
* Saturation safeguards against excessive concentration
* Structural alignment between power, accountability, and effort

Without such reforms, the trajectory points toward participation fatigue, superficial deliberation, entrenched power concentration, and increasing vulnerability to influence capture.

Governance is not sustained by idealism alone. It is sustained by properly engineered incentives.

Which of these roles best describes your involvement in the Cardano ecosystem? (Select all that apply)

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- ○ Publicly accessible blockchain explorer tools showing on-chain state and history
- ○ DRep profiles and published political / governance perspectives
- ○ Community forums or social media recommendations
- ○ SPO or other trusted community member endorsements
- ○ They don't look for information - they delegate to someone they already know
- ◉ They have not tried to find a DRep

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- ◉ DRep becoming inactive or missing votes
- ○ DRep voted in a way I disagreed with
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- ○ I would not change my delegation / Not applicable

M4/M5-A - Do you think DRep voting power has become more concentrated since the role was established? If so what do you think contributes most to this change? (Select one)

- ○ Difficult for ada holders to discover smaller or newer DReps
- ◉ Well-known DReps attract more delegation regardless of performance
- ○ Lack of incentives for delegating to smaller DReps
- ○ Ada holders don't actively manage or reconsider their delegations
- ○ Default delegation options in wallet applications
- ○ Ada holders choosing the same DRep as their SPO has chosen
- ○ Some DReps are simply more qualified or trusted
- ○ Genesis Ada given to large organizations who delegate to DReps
- ○ I don't believe voting power is overly concentrated
- ○ Other

M4/M5-B - What, if any, would most help distribute voting power more evenly across DReps? (Select one)

- ○ Better tools for discovering and comparing DReps
- ○ Incentives for delegating to smaller or newer DReps
- ◉ Limits on maximum voting power per DRep
- ○ More support for new DReps to establish themselves
- ○ Easier process to switch DReps
- ○ Encouraging ada holders to periodically review their delegation
- ○ No changes needed - current distribution is appropriate

M6-A - What would most help increase the number of DReps publishing on-chain rationales? (Select one)

- (●) Clearer templates or standards for rationale format
- ( ) Simpler tools for publishing rationales
- ( ) Incentives or rewards for publishing rationales
- ( ) Community recognition for DReps who consistently publish
- ( ) Making rationale publication a requirement for active DRep status
- ( ) Delegator pressure / delegators moving away from a DRep
- ( ) No changes needed - current publication rates are adequate

M7-A - What, if any, would most help increase the number of active DReps in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- ( ) Better onboarding resources and mentorship for new DReps
- ( ) Reduced deposit requirements to register as a DRep
- (●) Compensation or incentives for active DRep participation
- ( ) Improved tools for DReps to communicate with potential delegators
- ( ) Greater visibility for new DReps in discovery platforms
- ( ) Easier ways for a group of people to act as a DReps, rather than an individual
- ( ) No changes needed - current DRep numbers are adequate

M10-B - What is an acceptable timeframe for the Constitutional Committee to review and vote on a governance action? (Select one)

- ○ Within 1 epoch (5 days)
- ○ Within 2-3 epochs (10-15 days)
- ○ Within 4-6 epochs (20-30 days) - Maximum before action expires
- ◉ Depends on the complexity of the proposal
- ○ I don't have an expectation for CC response time

What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

N/A

Which of these roles best describes your involvement in the Cardano ecosystem? (Select all that apply)

- [x] Ada Holder
- [x] DRep (Delegated Representative)
- [ ] SPO (Stake Pool Operator)
- [x] CC (Constitutional Committee Member)
- [x] Proposal Submitter / Project Catalyst Veteran
- [x] Developer
- [ ] Researcher / Academic
- [x] General Community Member / Enthusiast
- [ ] Governance Tooling Projects
- [ ] Other Cardano Project

How long have you been actively serving as a DRep?

- ○ Less than 3 months
- ○ 3 to 6 months
- ○ 6 to 12 months
- ◉ 1 year or longer

Thank you!
Thank you for completing this survey. Your input will directly inform how we measure and improve Cardano's governance system.

Dette skjemaet ble opprettet på Input Output.

Google Skjemaer

Cardano Governance Survey for DReps

Thank you for participating in this survey. This research initiative aims to measure and improve governance on the Cardano blockchain. Your responses will help us understand governance participation, decision-making, and areas for improvement.

Resources available:

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M1-A - What, if any, is the biggest barrier preventing you from participating more actively in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- ○ Governance proposals are too technical to evaluate
- ○ Voting tools are difficult to access or use
- ○ Not enough time to review proposals before voting deadlines
- ○ Unclear what impact my participation would have / perception of lack of impact
- ○ Current deposit or fee requirements
- ◉ Inadequate compensation / incentives
- ○ Delays in Constitutional Committee decisions / rationale publication
- ○ Lack of confidence in ability to evaluate the safety / performance implications of technical governance actions (e.g., protocol parameter changes, hard forks)?
- ○ No significant barrier - I participate as much as I do or don't prefer

M1-B - What type of information would most help you make governance decisions? (Select one)

- (●) Expert analysis of proposal technical implications
- ( ) How DReps and SPOs are planning to vote
- ( ) Historical outcomes of similar past proposals
- ( ) Constitutional Committee's assessment of proposals
- ( ) Evaluation of whether projected cost aligns with similar past proposals
- ( ) I have sufficient information to make decisions

M2-A - What, if any, do you think is the biggest barrier preventing ada holders from delegating their voting power to a DRep to vote on their behalf? (Select one)

- (●) Hard to discover what DReps exist
- ( ) DReps don't clearly communicate their values or positions
- ( ) Difficult to compare DReps to each other
- ( ) Ada holders don't trust available DReps to represent their interests
- ( ) Ada holders prefer to vote directly
- ( ) No significant barrier - delegation is accessible

M2-B - Where do you think ada holders most commonly look for information when selecting a DRep? (Select one)

- ○ Publicly accessible governance tools for participating in governance workflows
- ○ Publicly accessible blockchain explorer tools showing on-chain state and history
- ○ DRep profiles and published political / governance perspectives
- ○ Community forums or social media recommendations
- ○ SPO or other trusted community member endorsements
- ◉ They don't look for information - they delegate to someone they already know
- ○ They have not tried to find a DRep

M3-A - Of these options, what would most likely cause delegators to change their DRep delegation? (Select one)

- ○ DRep not publishing on-chain rationales for their votes
- ○ DRep not providing accessible communication in informal channels
- ○ DRep becoming inactive or missing votes
- ○ DRep voted in a way I disagreed with
- ◉ Learning about a DRep with different values or voting patterns
- ○ I would not change my delegation / Not applicable

M4/M5-A - Do you think DRep voting power has become more concentrated since the role was established? If so what do you think contributes most to this change? (Select one)

- ○ Difficult for ada holders to discover smaller or newer DReps
- ○ Well-known DReps attract more delegation regardless of performance
- ◉ Lack of incentives for delegating to smaller DReps
- ○ Ada holders don't actively manage or reconsider their delegations
- ○ Default delegation options in wallet applications
- ○ Ada holders choosing the same DRep as their SPO has chosen
- ○ Some DReps are simply more qualified or trusted
- ○ Genesis Ada given to large organizations who delegate to DReps
- ○ I don't believe voting power is overly concentrated
- ○ Other

M4/M5-B - What, if any, would most help distribute voting power more evenly across DReps? (Select one)

- ○ Better tools for discovering and comparing DReps
- ○ Incentives for delegating to smaller or newer DReps
- ◉ Limits on maximum voting power per DRep
- ○ More support for new DReps to establish themselves
- ○ Easier process to switch DReps
- ○ Encouraging ada holders to periodically review their delegation
- ○ No changes needed - current distribution is appropriate

M6-A - What would most help increase the number of DReps publishing on-chain rationales? (Select one)

- ○ Clearer templates or standards for rationale format
- ○ Simpler tools for publishing rationales
- ◉ Incentives or rewards for publishing rationales
- ○ Community recognition for DReps who consistently publish
- ○ Making rationale publication a requirement for active DRep status
- ○ Delegator pressure / delegators moving away from a DRep
- ○ No changes needed - current publication rates are adequate

M7-A - What, if any, would most help increase the number of active DReps in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- ○ Better onboarding resources and mentorship for new DReps
- ○ Reduced deposit requirements to register as a DRep
- ○ Compensation or incentives for active DRep participation
- ○ Improved tools for DReps to communicate with potential delegators
- ○ Greater visibility for new DReps in discovery platforms
- ○ Easier ways for a group of people to act as a DReps, rather than an individual
- ◉ No changes needed - current DRep numbers are adequate

M10-B - What is an acceptable timeframe for the Constitutional Committee to review and vote on a governance action? (Select one)

- ○ Within 1 epoch (5 days)
- ◉ Within 2-3 epochs (10-15 days)
- ○ Within 4-6 epochs (20-30 days) - Maximum before action expires
- ○ Depends on the complexity of the proposal
- ○ I don't have an expectation for CC response time

What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

Which of these roles best describes your involvement in the Cardano ecosystem? (Select all that apply)

- [x] Ada Holder
- [x] DRep (Delegated Representative)
- [ ] SPO (Stake Pool Operator)
- [ ] CC (Constitutional Committee Member)
- [x] Proposal Submitter / Project Catalyst Veteran
- [ ] Developer
- [x] Researcher / Academic
- [x] General Community Member / Enthusiast
- [ ] Governance Tooling Projects
- [ ] Other Cardano Project

How long have you been actively serving as a DRep?

- ○ Less than 3 months
- ○ 3 to 6 months
- ◉ 6 to 12 months
- ○ 1 year or longer

Thank you!
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Google Skjemaer

Cardano Governance Survey for DReps

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M1-A - What, if any, is the biggest barrier preventing you from participating more actively in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- (●) Governance proposals are too technical to evaluate
- ( ) Voting tools are difficult to access or use
- ( ) Not enough time to review proposals before voting deadlines
- ( ) Unclear what impact my participation would have / perception of lack of impact
- ( ) Current deposit or fee requirements
- ( ) Inadequate compensation / incentives
- ( ) Delays in Constitutional Committee decisions / rationale publication
- ( ) Lack of confidence in ability to evaluate the safety / performance implications of technical governance actions (e.g., protocol parameter changes, hard forks)?
- ( ) No significant barrier - I participate as much as I do or don't prefer

M1-B - What type of information would most help you make governance decisions? (Select one)

- ○ Expert analysis of proposal technical implications
- ◉ How DReps and SPOs are planning to vote
- ○ Historical outcomes of similar past proposals
- ○ Constitutional Committee's assessment of proposals
- ○ Evaluation of whether projected cost aligns with similar past proposals
- ○ I have sufficient information to make decisions

M2-A - What, if any, do you think is the biggest barrier preventing ada holders from delegating their voting power to a DRep to vote on their behalf? (Select one)

- ◉ Hard to discover what DReps exist
- ○ DReps don't clearly communicate their values or positions
- ○ Difficult to compare DReps to each other
- ○ Ada holders don't trust available DReps to represent their interests
- ○ Ada holders prefer to vote directly
- ○ No significant barrier - delegation is accessible

M2-B - Where do you think ada holders most commonly look for information when selecting a DRep? (Select one)

- ○ Publicly accessible governance tools for participating in governance workflows
- ○ Publicly accessible blockchain explorer tools showing on-chain state and history
- ○ DRep profiles and published political / governance perspectives
- ○ Community forums or social media recommendations
- ○ SPO or other trusted community member endorsements
- ○ They don't look for information - they delegate to someone they already know
- ◉ They have not tried to find a DRep

M3-A - Of these options, what would most likely cause delegators to change their DRep delegation? (Select one)

- ○ DRep not publishing on-chain rationales for their votes
- ○ DRep not providing accessible communication in informal channels
- ◉ DRep becoming inactive or missing votes
- ○ DRep voted in a way I disagreed with
- ○ Learning about a DRep with different values or voting patterns
- ○ I would not change my delegation / Not applicable

M4/M5-A - Do you think DRep voting power has become more concentrated since the role was established? If so what do you think contributes most to this change? (Select one)

- ○ Difficult for ada holders to discover smaller or newer DReps
- ○ Well-known DReps attract more delegation regardless of performance
- ○ Lack of incentives for delegating to smaller DReps
- ◉ Ada holders don't actively manage or reconsider their delegations
- ○ Default delegation options in wallet applications
- ○ Ada holders choosing the same DRep as their SPO has chosen
- ○ Some DReps are simply more qualified or trusted
- ○ Genesis Ada given to large organizations who delegate to DReps
- ○ I don't believe voting power is overly concentrated
- ○ Other

M4/M5-B - What, if any, would most help distribute voting power more evenly across DReps? (Select one)

- ○ Better tools for discovering and comparing DReps
- ◉ Incentives for delegating to smaller or newer DReps
- ○ Limits on maximum voting power per DRep
- ○ More support for new DReps to establish themselves
- ○ Easier process to switch DReps
- ○ Encouraging ada holders to periodically review their delegation
- ○ No changes needed - current distribution is appropriate

M6-A - What would most help increase the number of DReps publishing on-chain rationales? (Select one)

- ○ Clearer templates or standards for rationale format
- ○ Simpler tools for publishing rationales
- ◉ Incentives or rewards for publishing rationales
- ○ Community recognition for DReps who consistently publish
- ○ Making rationale publication a requirement for active DRep status
- ○ Delegator pressure / delegators moving away from a DRep
- ○ No changes needed - current publication rates are adequate

M7-A - What, if any, would most help increase the number of active DReps in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- ○ Better onboarding resources and mentorship for new DReps
- ○ Reduced deposit requirements to register as a DRep
- ◉ Compensation or incentives for active DRep participation
- ○ Improved tools for DReps to communicate with potential delegators
- ○ Greater visibility for new DReps in discovery platforms
- ○ Easier ways for a group of people to act as a DReps, rather than an individual
- ○ No changes needed - current DRep numbers are adequate

M10-B - What is an acceptable timeframe for the Constitutional Committee to review and vote on a governance action? (Select one)

- ○ Within 1 epoch (5 days)
- ◉ Within 2-3 epochs (10-15 days)
- ○ Within 4-6 epochs (20-30 days) - Maximum before action expires
- ○ Depends on the complexity of the proposal
- ○ I don't have an expectation for CC response time

What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

AI chat tool to help summaries and come to a conclusion for votes. Data to easily see how others are voting and their rational.

Which of these roles best describes your involvement in the Cardano ecosystem? (Select all that apply)

- [ ] Ada Holder
- [x] DRep (Delegated Representative)
- [x] SPO (Stake Pool Operator)
- [ ] CC (Constitutional Committee Member)
- [ ] Proposal Submitter / Project Catalyst Veteran
- [ ] Developer
- [ ] Researcher / Academic
- [x] General Community Member / Enthusiast
- [ ] Governance Tooling Projects
- [x] Other Cardano Project

How long have you been actively serving as a DRep?

- ○ Less than 3 months
- ○ 3 to 6 months
- ○ 6 to 12 months
- ◉ 1 year or longer

Thank you!
Thank you for completing this survey. Your input will directly inform how we measure and improve Cardano's governance system.

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Google Skjemaer

Cardano Governance Survey for DReps

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M1-A - What, if any, is the biggest barrier preventing you from participating more actively in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- ○ Governance proposals are too technical to evaluate
- ○ Voting tools are difficult to access or use
- ○ Not enough time to review proposals before voting deadlines
- ○ Unclear what impact my participation would have / perception of lack of impact
- ○ Current deposit or fee requirements
- ○ Inadequate compensation / incentives
- ○ Delays in Constitutional Committee decisions / rationale publication
- ○ Lack of confidence in ability to evaluate the safety / performance implications of technical governance actions (e.g., protocol parameter changes, hard forks)?
- ◉ No significant barrier - I participate as much as I do or don't prefer

M1-B - What type of information would most help you make governance decisions? (Select one)

- (●) Expert analysis of proposal technical implications
- ( ) How DReps and SPOs are planning to vote
- ( ) Historical outcomes of similar past proposals
- ( ) Constitutional Committee's assessment of proposals
- ( ) Evaluation of whether projected cost aligns with similar past proposals
- ( ) I have sufficient information to make decisions

M2-A - What, if any, do you think is the biggest barrier preventing ada holders from delegating their voting power to a DRep to vote on their behalf? (Select one)

- ( ) Hard to discover what DReps exist
- ( ) DReps don't clearly communicate their values or positions
- (●) Difficult to compare DReps to each other
- ( ) Ada holders don't trust available DReps to represent their interests
- ( ) Ada holders prefer to vote directly
- ( ) No significant barrier - delegation is accessible

M2-B - Where do you think ada holders most commonly look for information when selecting a DRep? (Select one)

- ○ Publicly accessible governance tools for participating in governance workflows
- ○ Publicly accessible blockchain explorer tools showing on-chain state and history
- ○ DRep profiles and published political / governance perspectives
- ○ Community forums or social media recommendations
- ○ SPO or other trusted community member endorsements
- ◉ They don't look for information - they delegate to someone they already know
- ○ They have not tried to find a DRep

M3-A - Of these options, what would most likely cause delegators to change their DRep delegation? (Select one)

- ○ DRep not publishing on-chain rationales for their votes
- ○ DRep not providing accessible communication in informal channels
- ○ DRep becoming inactive or missing votes
- ○ DRep voted in a way I disagreed with
- ◉ Learning about a DRep with different values or voting patterns
- ○ I would not change my delegation / Not applicable

M4/M5-A - Do you think DRep voting power has become more concentrated since the role was established? If so what do you think contributes most to this change? (Select one)

- ○ Difficult for ada holders to discover smaller or newer DReps
- ○ Well-known DReps attract more delegation regardless of performance
- ○ Lack of incentives for delegating to smaller DReps
- ○ Ada holders don't actively manage or reconsider their delegations
- ◉ Default delegation options in wallet applications
- ○ Ada holders choosing the same DRep as their SPO has chosen
- ○ Some DReps are simply more qualified or trusted
- ○ Genesis Ada given to large organizations who delegate to DReps
- ○ I don't believe voting power is overly concentrated
- ○ Other

M4/M5-B - What, if any, would most help distribute voting power more evenly across DReps? (Select one)

- ◉ Better tools for discovering and comparing DReps
- ○ Incentives for delegating to smaller or newer DReps
- ○ Limits on maximum voting power per DRep
- ○ More support for new DReps to establish themselves
- ○ Easier process to switch DReps
- ○ Encouraging ada holders to periodically review their delegation
- ○ No changes needed - current distribution is appropriate

M6-A - What would most help increase the number of DReps publishing on-chain rationales? (Select one)

- ○ Clearer templates or standards for rationale format
- ○ Simpler tools for publishing rationales
- ○ Incentives or rewards for publishing rationales
- ◉ Community recognition for DReps who consistently publish
- ○ Making rationale publication a requirement for active DRep status
- ○ Delegator pressure / delegators moving away from a DRep
- ○ No changes needed - current publication rates are adequate

M7-A - What, if any, would most help increase the number of active DReps in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- ○ Better onboarding resources and mentorship for new DReps
- ○ Reduced deposit requirements to register as a DRep
- ○ Compensation or incentives for active DRep participation
- ○ Improved tools for DReps to communicate with potential delegators
- ○ Greater visibility for new DReps in discovery platforms
- ○ Easier ways for a group of people to act as a DReps, rather than an individual
- ◉ No changes needed - current DRep numbers are adequate

M10-B - What is an acceptable timeframe for the Constitutional Committee to review and vote on a governance action? (Select one)

- ○ Within 1 epoch (5 days)
- ◉ Within 2-3 epochs (10-15 days)
- ○ Within 4-6 epochs (20-30 days) - Maximum before action expires
- ○ Depends on the complexity of the proposal
- ○ I don't have an expectation for CC response time

What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

Better filters for DRep delegations.
- Over/Under a particular amount of ADA
- Over/Under participation rate
- Choose specific past governance actions and filter the DReps that voted according to the delegator's preferences.

and REMOVE the instant Emurgo/Eternl/etc delegations from wallets all together.

Which of these roles best describes your involvement in the Cardano ecosystem? (Select all that apply)

- [x] Ada Holder
- [x] DRep (Delegated Representative)
- [ ] SPO (Stake Pool Operator)
- [ ] CC (Constitutional Committee Member)
- [ ] Proposal Submitter / Project Catalyst Veteran
- [ ] Developer
- [ ] Researcher / Academic
- [x] General Community Member / Enthusiast
- [ ] Governance Tooling Projects
- [ ] Other Cardano Project

How long have you been actively serving as a DRep?

- ( ) Less than 3 months
- ( ) 3 to 6 months
- ( ) 6 to 12 months
- (•) 1 year or longer

Thank you!
Thank you for completing this survey. Your input will directly inform how we measure and improve Cardano's governance system.

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Google Skjemaer

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M1-A - What, if any, is the biggest barrier preventing you from participating more actively in Cardano governance? (Select one)

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- ◉ Not enough time to review proposals before voting deadlines
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- ○ Current deposit or fee requirements
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M1-B - What type of information would most help you make governance decisions? (Select one)

- ○ Expert analysis of proposal technical implications
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M2-A - What, if any, do you think is the biggest barrier preventing ada holders from delegating their voting power to a DRep to vote on their behalf? (Select one)

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- ◉ Difficult to compare DReps to each other
- ○ Ada holders don't trust available DReps to represent their interests
- ○ Ada holders prefer to vote directly
- ○ No significant barrier - delegation is accessible

M2-B - Where do you think ada holders most commonly look for information when selecting a DRep? (Select one)

- ○ Publicly accessible governance tools for participating in governance workflows
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- ◉ They have not tried to find a DRep

M3-A - Of these options, what would most likely cause delegators to change their DRep delegation? (Select one)

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- ○ DRep becoming inactive or missing votes
- ◉ DRep voted in a way I disagreed with
- ○ Learning about a DRep with different values or voting patterns
- ○ I would not change my delegation / Not applicable

M4/M5-A - Do you think DRep voting power has become more concentrated since the role was established? If so what do you think contributes most to this change? (Select one)

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M4/M5-B - What, if any, would most help distribute voting power more evenly across DReps? (Select one)

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- ○ Greater visibility for new DReps in discovery platforms
- ◉ Easier ways for a group of people to act as a DReps, rather than an individual
- ○ No changes needed - current DRep numbers are adequate

M10-B - What is an acceptable timeframe for the Constitutional Committee to review and vote on a governance action? (Select one)

- ○ Within 1 epoch (5 days)
- ○ Within 2-3 epochs (10-15 days)
- ○ Within 4-6 epochs (20-30 days) - Maximum before action expires
- ◉ Depends on the complexity of the proposal
- ○ I don't have an expectation for CC response time

What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

Limit DRep voting power, eliminate sketchy UX flows for auto-delegations in wallets like Yoroi, technical upgrade to allow formation of consortiums of DReps or some sort of grouping mechanism (facilitating groups being a DRep for example).

Additionally, better efficiency and ROI measurement from independent auditors like Intersect on past gov actions. Milestone updates are cool and all, but we need ROI analysis, and constructive criticism. If DReps don't understand what worked and what didn't from our strategy in 2025, we'll commit the same mistakes and over spending or misallocation in 2026. An independent auditor with a neutral view of the situation would be highly useful as 2026 budget approaches.

I'd also like to see treasury budget season to be much more streamlined, and "transparent". DRep fatigue is real, as new gov actions drop all the time. We cannot go against this, but for example, there's a consensus among core internal Cardano community that budget 2026 will open around April, yet no formal communications has been done, making it pure speculation, and allowing only those who have insider information to be up to date on where the "official" Budget 2026 process starts, and prepare accordingly. This limits those who may be interested in proposing their ideas, but have no clarity so far as to when that process will open, making it chaotic and probably unprepared for when the "right time" comes.

Which of these roles best describes your involvement in the Cardano ecosystem? (Select all that apply)

- [x] Ada Holder
- [x] DRep (Delegated Representative)
- [ ] SPO (Stake Pool Operator)
- [ ] CC (Constitutional Committee Member)
- [x] Proposal Submitter / Project Catalyst Veteran
- [ ] Developer
- [ ] Researcher / Academic
- [x] General Community Member / Enthusiast
- [ ] Governance Tooling Projects
- [x] Other Cardano Project

How long have you been actively serving as a DRep?

- ( ) Less than 3 months
- ( ) 3 to 6 months
- (•) 6 to 12 months
- ( ) 1 year or longer

Thank you!
Thank you for completing this survey. Your input will directly inform how we measure and improve Cardano's governance system.

Dette skjemaet ble opprettet på Input Output.

Google Skjemaer

Cardano Governance Survey for DReps

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Resources available:

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M1-A - What, if any, is the biggest barrier preventing you from participating more actively in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- ○ Governance proposals are too technical to evaluate
- ◉ Voting tools are difficult to access or use
- ○ Not enough time to review proposals before voting deadlines
- ○ Unclear what impact my participation would have / perception of lack of impact
- ○ Current deposit or fee requirements
- ○ Inadequate compensation / incentives
- ○ Delays in Constitutional Committee decisions / rationale publication
- ○ Lack of confidence in ability to evaluate the safety / performance implications of technical governance actions (e.g., protocol parameter changes, hard forks)?
- ○ No significant barrier - I participate as much as I do or don't prefer

M1-B - What type of information would most help you make governance decisions? (Select one)

- ○ Expert analysis of proposal technical implications
- ○ How DReps and SPOs are planning to vote
- ○ Historical outcomes of similar past proposals
- ○ Constitutional Committee's assessment of proposals
- ◉ Evaluation of whether projected cost aligns with similar past proposals
- ○ I have sufficient information to make decisions

M2-A - What, if any, do you think is the biggest barrier preventing ada holders from delegating their voting power to a DRep to vote on their behalf? (Select one)

- ○ Hard to discover what DReps exist
- ○ DReps don't clearly communicate their values or positions
- ◉ Difficult to compare DReps to each other
- ○ Ada holders don't trust available DReps to represent their interests
- ○ Ada holders prefer to vote directly
- ○ No significant barrier - delegation is accessible

M2-B - Where do you think ada holders most commonly look for information when selecting a DRep? (Select one)

- ○ Publicly accessible governance tools for participating in governance workflows
- ○ Publicly accessible blockchain explorer tools showing on-chain state and history
- ○ DRep profiles and published political / governance perspectives
- ◉ Community forums or social media recommendations
- ○ SPO or other trusted community member endorsements
- ○ They don't look for information - they delegate to someone they already know
- ○ They have not tried to find a DRep

M3-A - Of these options, what would most likely cause delegators to change their DRep delegation? (Select one)

- ○ DRep not publishing on-chain rationales for their votes
- ○ DRep not providing accessible communication in informal channels
- ○ DRep becoming inactive or missing votes
- ◉ DRep voted in a way I disagreed with
- ○ Learning about a DRep with different values or voting patterns
- ○ I would not change my delegation / Not applicable

M4/M5-A - Do you think DRep voting power has become more concentrated since the role was established? If so what do you think contributes most to this change? (Select one)

- ○ Difficult for ada holders to discover smaller or newer DReps
- ○ Well-known DReps attract more delegation regardless of performance
- ○ Lack of incentives for delegating to smaller DReps
- ○ Ada holders don't actively manage or reconsider their delegations
- ◉ Default delegation options in wallet applications
- ○ Ada holders choosing the same DRep as their SPO has chosen
- ○ Some DReps are simply more qualified or trusted
- ○ Genesis Ada given to large organizations who delegate to DReps
- ○ I don't believe voting power is overly concentrated
- ○ Other

M4/M5-B - What, if any, would most help distribute voting power more evenly across DReps? (Select one)

- ○ Better tools for discovering and comparing DReps
- ◉ Incentives for delegating to smaller or newer DReps
- ○ Limits on maximum voting power per DRep
- ○ More support for new DReps to establish themselves
- ○ Easier process to switch DReps
- ○ Encouraging ada holders to periodically review their delegation
- ○ No changes needed - current distribution is appropriate

M6-A - What would most help increase the number of DReps publishing on-chain rationales? (Select one)

- ○ Clearer templates or standards for rationale format
- ◉ Simpler tools for publishing rationales
- ○ Incentives or rewards for publishing rationales
- ○ Community recognition for DReps who consistently publish
- ○ Making rationale publication a requirement for active DRep status
- ○ Delegator pressure / delegators moving away from a DRep
- ○ No changes needed - current publication rates are adequate

M7-A - What, if any, would most help increase the number of active DReps in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- ○ Better onboarding resources and mentorship for new DReps
- ○ Reduced deposit requirements to register as a DRep
- ◉ Compensation or incentives for active DRep participation
- ○ Improved tools for DReps to communicate with potential delegators
- ○ Greater visibility for new DReps in discovery platforms
- ○ Easier ways for a group of people to act as a DReps, rather than an individual
- ○ No changes needed - current DRep numbers are adequate

M10-B - What is an acceptable timeframe for the Constitutional Committee to review and vote on a governance action? (Select one)

- ○ Within 1 epoch (5 days)
- ○ Within 2-3 epochs (10-15 days)
- ◉ Within 4-6 epochs (20-30 days) - Maximum before action expires
- ○ Depends on the complexity of the proposal
- ○ I don't have an expectation for CC response time

What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

Incentives to maximize decentralization and increase participation.

Which of these roles best describes your involvement in the Cardano ecosystem? (Select all that apply)

- [x] Ada Holder
- [x] DRep (Delegated Representative)
- [x] SPO (Stake Pool Operator)
- [ ] CC (Constitutional Committee Member)
- [ ] Proposal Submitter / Project Catalyst Veteran
- [x] Developer
- [x] Researcher / Academic
- [x] General Community Member / Enthusiast
- [x] Governance Tooling Projects
- [x] Other Cardano Project

How long have you been actively serving as a DRep?

- ○ Less than 3 months
- ○ 3 to 6 months
- ○ 6 to 12 months
- ◉ 1 year or longer

Thank you!
Thank you for completing this survey. Your input will directly inform how we measure and improve Cardano's governance system.

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Google Skjemaer

Cardano Governance Survey for DReps

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M1-A - What, if any, is the biggest barrier preventing you from participating more actively in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- ○ Governance proposals are too technical to evaluate
- ○ Voting tools are difficult to access or use
- ○ Not enough time to review proposals before voting deadlines
- ○ Unclear what impact my participation would have / perception of lack of impact
- ○ Current deposit or fee requirements
- ◉ Inadequate compensation / incentives
- ○ Delays in Constitutional Committee decisions / rationale publication
- ○ Lack of confidence in ability to evaluate the safety / performance implications of technical governance actions (e.g., protocol parameter changes, hard forks)?
- ○ No significant barrier - I participate as much as I do or don't prefer

M1-B - What type of information would most help you make governance decisions? (Select one)

- ○ Expert analysis of proposal technical implications
- ○ How DReps and SPOs are planning to vote
- ◉ Historical outcomes of similar past proposals
- ○ Constitutional Committee's assessment of proposals
- ○ Evaluation of whether projected cost aligns with similar past proposals
- ○ I have sufficient information to make decisions

M2-A - What, if any, do you think is the biggest barrier preventing ada holders from delegating their voting power to a DRep to vote on their behalf? (Select one)

- ○ Hard to discover what DReps exist
- ○ DReps don't clearly communicate their values or positions
- ◉ Difficult to compare DReps to each other
- ○ Ada holders don't trust available DReps to represent their interests
- ○ Ada holders prefer to vote directly
- ○ No significant barrier - delegation is accessible

M2-B - Where do you think ada holders most commonly look for information when selecting a DRep? (Select one)

- ○ Publicly accessible governance tools for participating in governance workflows
- ○ Publicly accessible blockchain explorer tools showing on-chain state and history
- ○ DRep profiles and published political / governance perspectives
- ○ Community forums or social media recommendations
- ○ SPO or other trusted community member endorsements
- ◉ They don't look for information - they delegate to someone they already know
- ○ They have not tried to find a DRep

M3-A - Of these options, what would most likely cause delegators to change their DRep delegation? (Select one)

- ○ DRep not publishing on-chain rationales for their votes
- ○ DRep not providing accessible communication in informal channels
- ◉ DRep becoming inactive or missing votes
- ○ DRep voted in a way I disagreed with
- ○ Learning about a DRep with different values or voting patterns
- ○ I would not change my delegation / Not applicable

M4/M5-A - Do you think DRep voting power has become more concentrated since the role was established? If so what do you think contributes most to this change? (Select one)

- ○ Difficult for ada holders to discover smaller or newer DReps
- ◉ Well-known DReps attract more delegation regardless of performance
- ○ Lack of incentives for delegating to smaller DReps
- ○ Ada holders don't actively manage or reconsider their delegations
- ○ Default delegation options in wallet applications
- ○ Ada holders choosing the same DRep as their SPO has chosen
- ○ Some DReps are simply more qualified or trusted
- ○ Genesis Ada given to large organizations who delegate to DReps
- ○ I don't believe voting power is overly concentrated
- ○ Other

M4/M5-B - What, if any, would most help distribute voting power more evenly across DReps? (Select one)

- ○ Better tools for discovering and comparing DReps
- ○ Incentives for delegating to smaller or newer DReps
- ◉ Limits on maximum voting power per DRep
- ○ More support for new DReps to establish themselves
- ○ Easier process to switch DReps
- ○ Encouraging ada holders to periodically review their delegation
- ○ No changes needed - current distribution is appropriate

M6-A - What would most help increase the number of DReps publishing on-chain rationales? (Select one)

- ○ Clearer templates or standards for rationale format
- ○ Simpler tools for publishing rationales
- ○ Incentives or rewards for publishing rationales
- ○ Community recognition for DReps who consistently publish
- ○ Making rationale publication a requirement for active DRep status
- ◉ Delegator pressure / delegators moving away from a DRep
- ○ No changes needed - current publication rates are adequate

M7-A - What, if any, would most help increase the number of active DReps in Cardano governance? (Select one)

- ○ Better onboarding resources and mentorship for new DReps
- ○ Reduced deposit requirements to register as a DRep
- ◉ Compensation or incentives for active DRep participation
- ○ Improved tools for DReps to communicate with potential delegators
- ○ Greater visibility for new DReps in discovery platforms
- ○ Easier ways for a group of people to act as a DReps, rather than an individual
- ○ No changes needed - current DRep numbers are adequate

M10-B - What is an acceptable timeframe for the Constitutional Committee to review and vote on a governance action? (Select one)

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- ○ Within 2-3 epochs (10-15 days)
- ○ Within 4-6 epochs (20-30 days) - Maximum before action expires
- ○ Depends on the complexity of the proposal
- ◉ I don't have an expectation for CC response time

What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

Plutocratic resistance. Merit accumulation for activity and consistency by DReps in the form of voting and rationale submission.

Which of these roles best describes your involvement in the Cardano ecosystem? (Select all that apply)

- [x] Ada Holder
- [x] DRep (Delegated Representative)
- [ ] SPO (Stake Pool Operator)
- [ ] CC (Constitutional Committee Member)
- [ ] Proposal Submitter / Project Catalyst Veteran
- [x] Developer
- [x] Researcher / Academic
- [x] General Community Member / Enthusiast
- [x] Governance Tooling Projects
- [ ] Other Cardano Project

How long have you been actively serving as a DRep?

- ○ Less than 3 months
- ○ 3 to 6 months
- ○ 6 to 12 months
- ◉ 1 year or longer

Thank you!
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M2-A - What, if any, do you think is the biggest barrier preventing ada holders from delegating their voting power to a DRep to vote on their behalf? (Select one)

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- ( ) No significant barrier - delegation is accessible

M2-B - Where do you think ada holders most commonly look for information when selecting a DRep? (Select one)

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M3-A - Of these options, what would most likely cause delegators to change their DRep delegation? (Select one)

- ( ) DRep not publishing on-chain rationales for their votes
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- ( ) Learning about a DRep with different values or voting patterns
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M4/M5-A - Do you think DRep voting power has become more concentrated since the role was established? If so what do you think contributes most to this change? (Select one)

- ○ Difficult for ada holders to discover smaller or newer DReps
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- ○ Genesis Ada given to large organizations who delegate to DReps
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- ○ Other

M4/M5-B - What, if any, would most help distribute voting power more evenly across DReps? (Select one)

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M6-A - What would most help increase the number of DReps publishing on-chain rationales? (Select one)

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- ○ Easier ways for a group of people to act as a DReps, rather than an individual
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M10-B - What is an acceptable timeframe for the Constitutional Committee to review and vote on a governance action? (Select one)

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- ○ Within 4-6 epochs (20-30 days) - Maximum before action expires
- ○ Depends on the complexity of the proposal
- ○ I don't have an expectation for CC response time

What improvements would you most like to see in Cardano's governance system?

Which of these roles best describes your involvement in the Cardano ecosystem? (Select all that apply)

- [ ] Ada Holder
- [x] DRep (Delegated Representative)
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- [x] Researcher / Academic
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- [ ] Governance Tooling Projects
- [ ] Other Cardano Project

How long have you been actively serving as a DRep?

- ○ Less than 3 months
- ○ 3 to 6 months
- ○ 6 to 12 months
- ◉ 1 year or longer

Thank you!
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Google Skjemaer